

Teach Your Assistant

Always Check: <https://docs.backboard.io/> for the latest.

What is RAG?

RAG stands for Retrieval Augmented Generation. In plain terms, it means giving your AI assistant access to real documents so it can answer questions based on actual content rather than just its training data. Instead of guessing, your assistant retrieves the relevant information from your files and generates an accurate response. Backboard handles all the complexity (indexing, searching, embedding) automatically. You just upload a file and start asking questions.

Overview

Upload a document to your assistant and ask it questions about the contents. Backboard automatically indexes and makes your document searchable, so your assistant can respond with answers grounded in real data.

PS: Join our Discord! <https://discord.gg/BpwsNrMt>

Step 1: Upload a Document and Ask a Question

```
Python
import asyncio
from backboard import BackboardClient

async def main():
    client = BackboardClient(api_key="YOUR_API_KEY")

    assistant = await client.create_assistant(
        name="Document Assistant",
        system_prompt="You are a helpful document analysis assistant"
    )

    document = await client.upload_document_to_assistant(
        assistant.assistant_id,
        "my_document.pdf"
    )

    print("Waiting for document to be indexed...")
```

```

while True:
    status = await client.get_document_status(document.document_id)
    if status.status == "indexed":
        print("Document indexed successfully!")
        break
    elif status.status == "failed":
        print(f"Document indexing failed: {status.status_message}")
        return
    await asyncio.sleep(2)

thread = await client.create_thread(assistant.assistant_id)

async for chunk in await client.add_message(
    thread_id=thread.thread_id,
    content="What are the key points in the uploaded document?",
    stream=True
):
    if chunk.get("type") == "content_streaming":
        c = chunk.get("content", "")
        if c:
            print(c, end="", flush=True)

print()

if __name__ == "__main__":
    asyncio.run(main())

```